Emotions and feelings

The same white can evoke **relief** in one of us and **pressure** in another, sometimes even both in one day. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Relief

A feeling that **there are fewer stimuli** and you can breathe out.

And why?

After a period full of changes, people and demands, simplicity may attract you. White bedding, a light wall, a desk without a pile of things. Perhaps you do not want a new life. You just don't want your room to remind you of ten unfinished tasks.

Ask yourself

“What would I like to put out of sight today?”

A new beginning

A feeling that it is **a clean sheet** and you can start in your own way.

And why?

A new notebook, an unpainted canvas, an empty shelf. Everything can still be different. At the same time it can press, because the first mark is no longer innocent.

And what if I asked you now?

“What would I begin if I did not need certainty?”

Celebration

A feeling that it is **an exceptional moment**.

And why?

A wedding dress, a christening, a suit for a garden party. White belongs to celebrations and attention. It can carry joy and also pressure for everything to look flawless.

And try answering now

“What am I looking forward to so much that I would wear something white for it?”

Emptiness

A feeling that **something is missing** here.

And why?

Perhaps you have a hospital stay behind you. Perhaps white reminds you of an unlived-in flat. Or you simply don't enjoy a surrounding where colours and personal things are missing.

And now one question for you

“What should belong here and is not here yet?”

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Feelings and experience

Deeper and slower states that settle in us. You often recognise them only after a while.

Purity, or control

A feeling that you must **keep watching yourself** so that nothing shows.

And why?

Imagine a white sofa. In one home it is the place where you sit down with tea. In another you approach it under supervision. If a white surrounding makes you watch every crumb, perhaps it is not bringing you the calm you promised yourself from it.

Ask yourself

"Where at home am I afraid to leave a trace, and why?"

Calm

A feeling that there is **quiet and light** and you need not explain anything.

And why?

A snowy landscape, a new duvet, morning light. White can accompany moments when you truly rest. Colour is part of the experience, not a substitute for rest.

And what if I asked you now?

"When did I last have nothing I had to do?"

Fear of a mistake

A feeling that **anything you spoil** will show.

And why?

On white every print, stain and stroke shows. A home should not be a place where you are afraid to leave evidence that you live in it. The colour itself demands nothing. The demand comes from what has stuck to it.

And try answering now

"Whose voice in me says that nothing must be spoiled?"

Freshness

A feeling that it is **fresh and light**.

And why?

A white shirt in summer, a blossom, foam on water, birch bark or clouds. White here is not sterile and has no need to be lifeless.

And now one question for you

"Where did I last see a white that was alive?"

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My white is not the same as your white

The colour itself **experiences nothing**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the **experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes a **shortcut**. That is why **your own reaction** is the most important.

- **White dress**
  For one a wedding, for another a farewell.
- **White coat**
  For one care, for another a surgery she wants to leave.
- **White room**
  For one light, for another an empty flat.
- **White duvet**
  For one home, for another a hotel.
- **White paper**
  For one an invitation, for another an exam.

Does it really make you look bigger?

Light clothing can under certain conditions look more voluminous than dark. The perceived size, though, is also affected by the cut, material, folds, shine, background and lighting. A white shirt alone does not add kilograms to the body. It changes its visual look. A loose black tunic need not look narrower than a well-fitting white dress.

"I don't have the figure for white"

Try to notice who is saying that sentence. You, looking at a specific garment? Or do you hear in your head someone's old remark again? You may want to emphasise a certain part of the body and leave another less conspicuous. That is your choice. But you need not put white aside entirely because supposedly one may wear it only after losing weight.

How to try white without talking yourself into it

Compare snow, cream and broken white near the face in the same light. Then try the garment in motion. Sit, walk around, raise your arms. That the fabric pulls across your hips is not white's opinion of your body. It is information about the cut. **White can be your choice. It does not have to be your obligation.**

Ask yourself

"Which sentence about white is loudest in me? Whose is it, actually?"

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